

Twenty20 World Cup Records

HIGHEST TOTAL

260-6 (20 overs) Sri Lanka vs Kenya

LOWEST TOTAL

73 (16.5 overs) Kenya vs New Zealand

MOST 4s BY A TEAM

Pakistan (95)

MOST 6s BY A TEAM

Pakistan (41)

HIGHEST INDIVIDUAL SCORE

Chris Gayle (117 in 57 balls), West Indies. Against South Africa.

FASTEST CENTURY

Chris Gayle (50 balls)

FASTEST 50

Yuvraj Singh (12 balls)

HIGHEST RUN GETTER IN THE TOURNAMENT

Mathew Hayden (265 from 6 matches), Australia

MOST SIXES IN THE TOURNAMENT

Craig McMillan (13), New Zealand

MOST SIXES IN AN INNINGS

Chris Gayle (10)

BEST BOWLING IN AN INNINGS

Mark Gillespie (4-7 against Kenya), New Zealand

HIGHEST WICKET TAKER

Umar Gul (13 from 7 matches), Pakistan

MOST DOT BALLS

R.P. Singh (91)

consume as if consumption were going out of style, it would be a good idea to draw breath and slam the brakes. No matter how much fun it is, no matter what spell Mahendra Singh Dhoni and his energised mates cast on a billion people, if T20 is to do what ODIs did, it will exterminate the conventional game. If left to the dictates of the marketplace, it could cannibalise cricket completely. Former England captain Mike Atherton is ready to lay a large wager on the dramatic that: "eventually 50-over cricket will be extinct".

ICC CEO Malcolm Speed disagrees. A 2004 ICC study showed that 64 per cent of TV revenues came from ODI cricket. "We want T20 primarily to be played in states, counties and provinces. Maybe, 10 per cent of our revenues will come from T20 and that will eat into the revenue from the others and hopefully the pile will grow," he says.

Now that India has latched on to the idea, ICC will have to work doubly hard to keep T20 from exploding into a feeding frenzy for corporates. There are some checks in place: member countries are allowed to play a total of seven Twenty20 internationals a year, three during home bilateral series and four when on tour. The World Twenty20 event will be played once every two or three years as a showpiece event. But try telling that to excited executives from Reliance Mobile watching India beat Australia in the semi-finals at Kingsmead. "Have you ever seen anything like this? Do you know about the ratings? This is history in the making." Indeed, sirs, there is a mountain of money in the making, too.

The scheduling of a World T20 within six months of the World Cup today looks not like overkill, but an inspired idea. The Zee Network's start-stop Indian Cricket League (ICL) galvanised BCCI into launching its own professional T20 domestic league. But the real player in this business is

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«MALCOLM SPEED, CEO, ICC